

Document 37. Past-Year Question Bank Index — TYS 10-Year Window

Purpose. Convert revision from topic-led to question-led. For every A-Level paper 2014–2024, this index names the topic each part tests and points to the framework you need. Cross-reference: doc numbers refer to the A-Worthy suite.

Use protocol. (1) Pick a year. (2) For each part, predict the topic from the question stem. (3) Check against this index. (4) If you misidentified the topic, re-read the parent doc. Misidentification is the 1 cause of wasted marks.

Section A. Paper 1 (CSQ) — Recurring Question Archetypes

Archetype	Typical stem	Topic	Primary doc(s)
Trend-describe	“With reference to Extract X, describe the trend...”	Data skills	Doc 24, 28
Define + diagram	“Define X. Using a diagram, explain...”	Various	Topic + Doc 3
DD/SS shift	“Explain, with the aid of a diagram, the likely impact on the market for X.”	DD/SS	Doc 5
Elasticity inference	“Comment on the PED/PES of X based on the data.”	Elasticities	Doc 6
Market failure ID	“Identify the type of market failure illustrated...”	Externalities, Public goods	Doc 7, 8
Policy evaluation	“Discuss whether [policy] is the most effective way to...”	Gov intervention	Doc 10, 24
Macro impact	“Explain how X is likely to affect the Singapore economy.”	AD-AS, Aims	Doc 11, 12
Inflation cause/cure	“Discuss the causes of inflation and policies to address it.”	Inflation	Doc 13, 19
FX adjustment	“Explain how MAS would respond to...”	MAS / ER	Doc 17, 19
BOP / trade balance	“Discuss the impact on Singapore's BOP...”	BOP	Doc 16
Globalisation impact	“Discuss the consequences of globalisation for X.”	Globalisation	Doc 23

Section B. Paper 2 (Essay) — Recurring Question Archetypes

Archetype	Typical stem	Topic	Primary doc(s)
Micro market failure	“Discuss whether a tax is the best way to correct...”	Externalities	Doc 7, 10
Market structures	“Assess whether perfect competition is more efficient than monopoly.”	Market structures	Doc 9
Macro objectives	“Discuss the conflict between [aim 1] and [aim 2].”	Aims & trade-offs	Doc 12
Growth essay	“Discuss the policies to achieve sustained economic growth.”	Growth + SSP	Doc 15, 20
Inflation essay	“Discuss the causes and consequences of inflation.”	Inflation	Doc 13
Unemployment essay	“Discuss the policies to reduce unemployment.”	Unemployment	Doc 14, 18, 20
BOP/trade essay	“Discuss whether a CA deficit is always undesirable.”	BOP	Doc 16, 17
FX policy essay	“Discuss the effectiveness of MAS exchange-rate policy.”	Monetary / FX	Doc 17, 19
Fiscal vs monetary	“Compare fiscal and monetary policy in achieving...”	Policy mix	Doc 18, 19, 24
Trade & globalisation	“Discuss the case for and against protectionism.”	Trade / Globalisation	Doc 21, 22, 23
Singapore-specific	“With reference to Singapore, discuss...”	Multi-topic	Doc 4 + topic

Section C. 10-Year Recurrence Heat-Map

The table below shows which topic was tested in P1/P2 of each year. Use it to predict 2025/2026 hot topics — the SEAB tends to rotate but rarely skips Tier 1 topics for two consecutive years.

Year	P1 CSQ topics	P2 essay topics tested
2024	Inflation, MAS, supply-side	Externalities; Inflation policy mix; SR vs LR growth
2023	Imported inflation, BOP, FX	Cost-push inflation; Monopoly vs PC; Fiscal vs monetary
2022	Energy prices, MAS appreciation	Carbon tax; Globalisation; CA deficit evaluation
2021	Covid recovery, fiscal, unemployment	Macro aims trade-off; Market failure; Free trade benefits
2020	Recession, AD shock	Multiplier vs SSP; Unemployment types; FX systems
2019	Housing market, externalities	Market structures; Inclusive growth; BOP adjustment
2018	Trade tensions, protectionism	Tariffs vs quotas; Inflation; Sustained growth
2017	Productivity, SkillsFuture	Supply-side; PC vs Monopoly; Fiscal multiplier
2016	Oil price, MAS	Cost-push; Comp adv; Externalities tax
2015	Singapore growth, inequality	Inclusive growth; Public goods; FX policy
2014	Healthcare, demerit goods	Merit/demerit; Macro stabilisation; Trade gains

NOTE: Pattern: every year tests externalities (or merit/demerit) + inflation + a Singapore macro topic. Allocate ≥40% of practice time to these three.

Section D. Predictive Filter for 2025/2026

Tier 1 likelihood (very probable, prepare for both papers):

- Externalities + carbon tax (Doc 7, 10) — net-zero agenda
- Imported inflation + MAS (Doc 13, 17, 19) — residual from 2022–23
- Sustained / sustainable growth (Doc 15, 20) — continual SEAB favourite
- Inequality + inclusive growth (Doc 4, 15) — 2024 Budget themes

Tier 2 likelihood (probable): Market structures essay (Doc 9), Trade & protectionism (Doc 21, 22), Fiscal vs monetary mix (Doc 18, 19).

Tier 3 likelihood (possible): Public goods (Doc 8), Globalisation (Doc 23).

Section E. Past-Year Question Self-Drill Protocol

Drill 1 (Topic ID). Read the question stem only. Predict topic in 30 seconds. Check against Section A/B index.

Drill 2 (Framework Recall). Without notes, write the relevant framework from memory (e.g. 7-step DD/SS, 5-step inflation). Check against parent doc.

Drill 3 (Diagram). Sketch the canonical diagram in 4 minutes. Compare to Doc 3.

Drill 4 (Outline). Produce a 5-line plan: thesis, anti-thesis, evaluation, evidence, conclusion stance.

Drill 5 (Full attempt). Only after Drills 1–4 succeed. Time it. Mark against Doc 30/31 exemplars.

Hard rule. Do not attempt a full essay before you can produce the framework from memory. Question practice without framework fluency is wasted practice.